

[IJMR ms#96541] Author Response/Comments on "Healthcare Analytics Challenges: A Three-Pillar Framework Connecting Analytics Maturity, Workforce Agility, and Technical Enablement"

1 message

Samuel Harrold <no-reply@jmir.org>

Sat, Jul 11, 2026 at 2:42 PM

Reply-To: Samuel Harrold <samuel.harrold@gmail.com>

To: Matthew Balcarras <matt.balcarras@jmir.org>

Cc: Samuel Harrold <samuel.harrold@gmail.com>

We thank the editor and both reviewers for their time across two rounds of review. This revision addresses the three editorial items (manuscript length, reference DOIs, and table/figure formatting) and Reviewer T's suggestion to add figure captions. In the course of the reference audit we also made a small number of voluntary corrections, disclosed at the end of this letter, so that every citation and statistic matches its verified source. No reviewer-requested content from the first revision has been removed.

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EDITORIAL COMMENTS (Decision B)

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COMMENT (Editor): Please see this link for details on manuscript length, the current version is too long.

RESPONSE: The manuscript has been shortened to within the 5,000-word Viewpoint limit under JMIR's published counting method ("Which elements of my article are included in the word count?", which includes the title, abstract, keywords, body, table content and captions, figure captions, and end-matter sections, and excludes references, author metadata, figure image content, and multimedia appendices). By that method the previous submission measured approximately 5,430 words; the revision measures 4,990. The reduction was achieved by:

1. Moving the full Three-Pillar Assessment Rubric (three tables with Low/Medium/High scoring anchors and evidence citations) to a new Multimedia Appendix 2, following JMIR's guidance that lengthy tables are better suited to appendices. An abridged one-table summary of the nine indicators remains in the main text (Table 2), with a pointer to the appendix. All sources cited in the appendix rubric also remain cited in the main text and reference list.
 2. Shortening the two figure descriptions into concise numbered captions with brief explanatory footnotes (see Reviewer T below).
 3. Tightening prose throughout and shortening the abstract from 305 to 270 words.
- No substantive claim, statistic, construct, worked example, or reviewer-requested addition from the first revision was removed.

COMMENT (Editor): The reference list includes items with incorrect or invalid DOIs. Please review all references for accuracy, appropriateness and validity.

RESPONSE: We conducted a complete audit of the reference list. Every entry was checked for (a) DOI registration at doi.org, (b) agreement between the entry's title, authors, year, venue, volume, issue, and pages and the DOI's registered Crossref record, and (c) support for the specific claim cited to it, verified against the full text or publisher record wherever available. As a result:

- 8 incorrect or invalid DOIs were corrected (several were valid DOIs that resolved to a different article, typically citation-manager autofill errors; the corrected entries also received the right volume, issue, and page numbers, and in two cases the right journal or conference).
- DOIs were added to 9 entries that lacked them; 25 entries legitimately without DOIs (reports, news, and web resources) were verified by URL.
- 2 duplicate entries were removed.
- 7 references were removed or replaced after verification: two whose publisher site no longer serves any content, one student research report replaced by the established IEEE Spectrum account of the same case, one inaccessible thesis replaced by an already-cited peer-reviewed source that supports the same point, one press release replaced by the canonical scholarly source for the claim it supported, one removed from two sentences whose specific claims its content did not support, and one whose claim we re-grounded in two sources already in the reference list.
- Author names were corrected against publisher records in 29 entries (including wrong or incomplete given names, missing co-authors, and malformed name-list formatting that rendered incorrectly in the reference list), and bibliographic fields (volume, issue, pages) were completed throughout.

The revised list contains 84 references; every DOI resolves and matches its registered metadata.

COMMENT (Editor): Please ensure that all tables and figures are included in the manuscript in proper format so that they can be viewed correctly. The current version has text that should probably be in tables but is not formatted in a way that can be viewed clearly.

RESPONSE: We identified and fixed the root cause: the Word template style applied to tables defined no borders, so in the reviewed document the tables rendered as unaligned text without gridlines. The revision addresses this in three ways:

1. The table style now draws full gridlines with a heavier header rule, so both tables display as clearly bounded tables in Word.
2. Tables are numbered with captions above them ("Table 1.", "Table 2.") and are cited in the text.
3. The three dense five-column rubric tables were moved to Multimedia Appendix 2 (see the length response above), leaving two compact tables in the main text. The appendix presents the rubric as three bordered tables with its own resolved reference list.

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REVIEWER T

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COMMENT: Thank you for the revision. The author has satisfactorily addressed my concerns, and I have no further questions. One minor suggestion is to add figure captions. You currently have footnotes for each figure; please include captions as well.

RESPONSE: Thank you; done. Each figure now carries a short numbered caption in the document's caption style ("Figure 1. Human-in-the-Loop Knowledge Governance (HITL-KG) architecture." and "Figure 2. The six-step Validated Query Cycle and its mapping to the three pillars."), followed by a brief explanatory footnote paragraph describing the steps shown. The previous long descriptions rendered as unnumbered text beneath each figure, which, as the reviewer observed, read as footnotes without captions; the revision provides both elements distinctly. The footnote for Figure 1 retains the description of the feedback loop from organizational memory to the knowledge base added in the first revision.

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REVIEWER Q

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COMMENT: Thank you for addressing the reviewers' comments. The current draft has sufficient potential for publication in IJMR. My only recommendation is that the proposed model has strong potential to be further expanded and empirically evaluated. Two particularly promising directions for future work are: 1. Empirical assessment of the human-in-the-loop component... 2. Comparative evaluation against existing models... While I do not consider these analyses essential for the current manuscript, I believe they represent valuable avenues for future research.

RESPONSE: Thank you for this assessment and for the constructive engagement across both rounds. We agree with both directions, and they correspond to the priority questions already identified in the manuscript's Conclusion: whether HITL-KG-mediated natural language to SQL workflows reduce error rates, recovery time, and rework compared with baseline tooling (the comparative evaluation), and how pillar scores correlate with observed continuity of analytics performance during turnover (the empirical assessment of the framework, including its human-in-the-loop component). These questions are the design basis for a planned companion empirical study using synthetic clinical data, and we look forward to reporting those results.

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ADDITIONAL CHANGES (disclosed for transparency)

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The reference audit prompted a small number of voluntary corrections beyond the requested items. None changes the manuscript's argument:

1. Construct attribution. The Introduction previously presented "Institutional Amnesia" as a term we defined. The term is established in public administration (Pollitt 2000, Prometheus; Stark and Head 2019, Journal of European Public Policy), and the underlying construct is studied in organization science as "organizational forgetting" (de Holan and Phillips 2004, Management Science; Rao and Argote 2006, already cited). The definition sentence now credits both literatures, and the paper's contribution is framed as specializing the construct to healthcare analytics. Three references were added.

2. Statistic precision. During full-text verification we tightened three statements to match their sources exactly: the Ang and Slaughter 2004 sentence now states the finding's actual scope (technical IT staff in organizations where IT is a support function, a category that includes healthcare delivery, had the lowest expected tenure at 2.9 years), rather than attributing the figure to healthcare IT staff specifically; an operational workforce statistic whose cited source did not

contain it was replaced with figures from two peer-reviewed global meta-analyses already suited to the claim (global nurse turnover of 16%-18% annually; Ren et al. 2024, Journal of Nursing Management; Wu et al. 2024, Nursing Open); and the organizational-resilience sentence now claims only the no-consensus finding its cited systematic review supports.

3. Citation substitution. One reference added in the first revision to the Limitations section (Konrad and Saidizand 2022, an institutional repository thesis) became inaccessible at its source; it was replaced with Ledikwe et al. 2013 (Human Resources for Health), already in the reference list, which directly supports the same point about investment in training.

4. Generative AI disclosure (attestation). The disclosure in the Acknowledgments is unchanged: generative AI (Gemini CLI and Claude Code) was used to assist manuscript editing, language refinement, literature search, and reference verification; it was not used to generate research findings, data, or conclusions; the author conducted the research and verified all claims, citations, and AI-assisted text.

We thank the editor and reviewers again for their time. We believe the revision resolves the remaining editorial items while preserving all content from the peer-reviewed first revision, and we welcome any further guidance.

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[Link for editor: <https://www.i-jmr.org/editor/submissionReview/96541>

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